



(Don't Write anything in this Area)

- 3.c) Examine the various methodologies employed in the study of human growth, analysing their strengths and limitations in advancing our understanding of the complex process of human growth and development. (15 Marks)

As per Malina, growth is the incremental processing of growth older. It includes hypertrophy, hyperplasia and accretion.

To measure the human growth, three methods are used :-

Longitudinal method

A set of population is being studied with a age group for longer duration of time.

Merits

- (i) It ~~saves~~ time, energy, money and resources.
- (ii) It helps us to analyse and

understand the differential pattern of individual growth.

(ii) It takes into consideration of variations in growth pattern, depending upon their environment (Cohort effect)

(iii) It further gives us the reliable data → as it is long study.

Demerits

(i) It is time taking and Resource intensive

(ii) The problem of attrition of the people
(E) → BSID → chart by Balley for child growth

Semi-longitudinal

In this method, different age group people are taken and studied at ~~one~~ time. ~~different intervals~~ one time

Merits

(i) It saves time and resources

(ii) No issue of attrition of the people.

(iii) Comparative analysis of the growth pattern across the different group.

~~(iv) can be generalised.~~

Demerits → (i) cohort effect
(ii) differential growth pattern

↓ making it complex.

(iv) Can't be generalised.

(Eg) → Framingham study in UK of the Cardiovascular disease; it is genetically during young age and environmentally during elder stage.

~~can~~ Mixed Method → Here the different age group people are studied at different interval of time.

Merit → holistic growth chart
→ differential growth pattern

can be generalised

→ used by health policy maker

Hence, we can see that these methods are used for growth study.

Demerit
↓
time taking
attrition
Resource Constraint